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Man sues AT&T, saying he lost \$1.8 million in cryptocurrency because of a SIM card hack. <https://digit.in/nov19-68>

Samsung Galaxy M30S

An improved Galaxy M30

With the better part of 2019 now behind us, Samsung has brought in a refresh with its Galaxy M30S. Let's find out how it fares.

Build and Design

The Galaxy M30S looks almost exactly like the original Galaxy M30. The rear panel has a dual-tone effect but the colour transition now happens horizontally. The Galaxy M30S is fairly grippy to hold if your hands are dry but tends to get slippery with traces of oil or sweat. The camera rectangle sits flush with the back panel as does the fingerprint scanner but is placed a bit high up for comfort. The front face a fairly thick chin, and a U-shaped notch at the top. All in all, the Galaxy M30S looks fairly attractive.

The right side of the device houses the power and volume buttons. These are placed too close to the top edge, making one-handed use difficult. All buttons work well but could do with a bit more click. The fingerprint scanner on the review unit worked quite quickly, and the face unlock feature worked four out of five times.

Display and audio

The display is a 6.4-inch Super AMOLED with a resolution of 1080x2340. We recorded a maximum brightness of 627 nits on the review unit's screen, which is well over Samsung's claimed figure of 420 nits. The display is colourful for everyday activities. The thin earpiece strip, which sits just above the selfie camera, was loud enough for calls indoors.

Battery

The Galaxy M30S comes with a massive 6000mAh Li-ion battery with 15W fast charging. On our standard battery benchmark test, the review unit scored a chart-topping 14 hours, 30 minutes.



Price
₹13,999



PERFORMANCE.....	70
FEATURES.....	84
DESIGN.....	73
VALUE.....	65

After an hour of GPS navigation, the phone showed an 8 percent drop. After 15 minutes of playing PUBG Mobile, the phone showed a 4-percent drop, which is quite normal. Charging the phone from near-zero back up to full took close to two hours, which is understandable given the battery's high capacity.

Performance and gaming

The Galaxy M30S comes with an updated chipset, the 10-nanometre Exynos 9611. The new chipset employs eight cores but at higher clock speeds than the previous gen. The GPU too is a slightly newer Mali-G72 MP3. Our review unit came with 6GB of RAM and 128GB of internal storage.

The device fared quite well on CPU and GPU benchmark tests. On AnTuTu 7.0, the Galaxy M30S picked up 132160 points, as opposed to the Galaxy M30's 107705. On PCMark 2.0, the Galaxy M30S scored 5626 points. On 3DMark's Sling Shot, it bagged 1548 points.

Everyday performance of the review unit was good but not great. Apps such as WhatsApp and Gmail took up to two seconds to open. With a game running, switching apps became slow. The camera app had frequent stutters during use, which only got worse in low light.

Gaming on the review unit wasn't a completely smooth experience but it wasn't bad. PUBG Mobile ran on high graphics by default and averaged 32 frames per second on Gamebench.

The Galaxy M30S ships with Android 9 Pie with Samsung's One UI running atop. The UI supports Samsung's version of gesture-based navigation.

Camera

The Galaxy M30S sports a 48MP sensor, an 8MP ultra-wide sensor as well as a 5MP depth sensor.

Photos taken in daylight through the primary sensor are bright but not very colourful. The ultra-wide sensor snaps a bit more colour and contrast. In low light, photos from the primary sensor display some distortion but not enough to make things ugly. The Live Focus mode tends to cut the subject in the foreground off around the edges at times.

Selfies come out fine but can do with a bit more sharpness. The Live Focus mode for selfies works well but tends to miss the edges at times.

All things considered, the Galaxy M30S' camera is ideal for casual photographers but not for enthusiasts.

Bottomline

There's absolutely no price difference between the top-end variant of the original Galaxy M30 and the more recent Galaxy M30S, so, it makes a lot of sense to go in for the latter. The improved chipset and larger battery really do make a difference. The Samsung Galaxy M30S is a good phone, but with a few less-than-obvious flaws. The chipset can't handle heavy multitasking, there are frequent stutters in the camera app and the glossy plastic finish of the back panel doesn't look premium. However, the Samsung Galaxy M30S is still a solid budget – mid-range purchase.

—Vignesh Giridharan

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.40-inch (1080x2340) | PROCESSOR: Samsung Exynos 9611 | FRONT CAMERA: 16MP | REAR CAMERA: 48MP + 5MP + 8MP | RAM: 4GB | STORAGE: 64GB | BATTERY CAPACITY: 6000mAh | OS: Android 9 Pie

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